

### Question 53 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

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**Analyse why a training program may receive positive participant reactions but still fail to improve job performance.**

#### *Answer*

This is the classic gap between Kirkpatrick level 1 and levels 3–4. Positive reaction is not performance.

- 1. Entertainment vs learning:** Enjoyable trainers and venues raise reaction without building skill.
- 2. No real learning (level 2 fail):** Content too easy, too hard, or not practised; people leave happy but incompetent.
- 3. Wrong need:** TNA missing—performance problem was not a skill gap (tools, workload, process).
- 4. No transfer climate:** Bosses do not allow new methods; old SOPs and peer pressure restore old behaviour.
- 5. No opportunity:** Skills unused for months are forgotten.
- 6. Conflicting appraisal/rewards:** Employees are measured on speed, not the quality method taught.
- 7. Lack of follow-up:** No coaching, action plan or refresher after the event.
- 8. Analytical conclusion:** Reaction is a weak predictor of job performance; HRD must design for learning, behaviour support and results, not applause.

***Conclusion.** Positive reactions with no performance gain usually mean the programme was pleasant but diagnostically or contextually wrong.*